

Six things you can measure about a fantasy manager

Fat Man's Fantasy, 2022–2025. Each figure is a *per-season* average, with the manager's rank of 14 in small type. Ordered by what the model at the foot of the page predicts from these six numbers alone.

	Waiver claims	Points per FAAB \$	Overpaid per bid	Busts in rounds 1–4	Steals in rounds 8–14	Started the right players
rpthorp	55 ¹	3.1 ⁴	\$2.06 ²	0.25 ⁵	0.75 ⁵	93.3% ⁴
BigDog11	35 ⁸	4.4 ¹	\$8.23 ¹⁰	0.25 ⁴	1.50 ²	91.9% ¹⁰
fishy11	18 ¹²	3.1 ⁵	\$8.11 ⁹	0.00 ¹	0.50 ⁸	93.4% ²
robbbbb	52 ³	3.0 ⁶	\$2.14 ³	0.50 ⁷	0.25 ¹⁴	93.3% ³
robertwneal2	53 ²	3.6 ³	\$2.04 ¹	0.50 ⁹	0.75 ⁶	92.0% ⁹
buddygalletti	22 ¹¹	1.3 ¹³	\$8.56 ¹¹	0.25 ³	0.50 ⁷	94.1% ¹
DakodiacBear	30 ⁹	2.4 ⁹	\$3.00 ⁴	0.25 ²	0.25 ¹²	92.8% ⁶
Spaceman917	27 ¹⁰	2.4 ⁸	\$4.67 ⁷	0.50 ⁶	1.50 ¹	91.1% ¹⁴
CaseyForeverUnclean	16 ¹³	2.3 ¹⁰	\$5.49 ⁸	0.50 ⁸	0.50 ¹¹	92.1% ⁸
SamBam805	37 ⁶	4.0 ²	\$3.92 ⁵	1.00 ¹¹	0.50 ¹⁰	92.3% ⁷
otterboi	46 ⁴	2.8 ⁷	\$4.54 ⁶	1.00 ¹⁰	0.25 ¹³	93.0% ⁵
CaptainBigCup	38 ⁵	2.2 ¹¹	\$9.01 ¹²	1.00 ¹²	1.33 ³	91.1% ¹³
mikeion	11 ¹⁴	0.9 ¹⁴	\$9.50 ¹³	1.25 ¹³	1.25 ⁴	91.8% ¹¹
Gordonulus	35 ⁷	1.9 ¹²	\$10.17 ¹⁴	1.50 ¹⁴	0.50 ⁹	91.5% ¹²
league median	35	2.6	\$5.08	0.50	0.50	92.2%

What the columns mean

- **Waiver claims** — how many you put in per season, the ones you lost included.
- **Points per FAAB dollar** — points a claimed player scored *while you started him*, divided by what you paid. Bench points do not count.
- **Overpaid per bid** — how far above the *next-highest* bid you landed on a contested claim: money you did not have to spend.
- **Busts in rounds 1–4** — early picks finishing 50+ points below what that slot usually returns. Malik Nabers, taken 14th in 2025, played four games and came in 119 points light: one bust.
- **Steals in rounds 8–14** — the mirror of a bust, same threshold. Rico Dowdle, taken 154th in 2025, finished RB17: one steal.
- **Started the right players** — the share of your best possible lineup you actually started, judged with hindsight.

Why none of this explains very much

Not because managers are alike. The spread of season win rates has an SD of **0.152**; fourteen tosses of a fair coin give **0.134** of that alone, leaving **0.072** for real differences — a good manager here sits near a **0.57** weekly win probability and a poor one near **0.43**, eight wins against six. The gap is real; the noise is simply twice its size.

That caps what any model can reach. Suppose you somehow knew every manager's *true* long-run scoring level — not his noisy fourteen-week sample, but the exact figure he would converge to over hundreds of weeks. Predicting a single season's record from that alone would get you about **23%** of the way, because the season is still fourteen weighted coin flips laid on top. It is the batting-average problem: a true .300 hitter and a true .270 hitter swap places constantly over fourteen at-bats.

So 23% is the ceiling for anybody, with any data. These six columns reach 6% of the total, about a quarter of what is reachable, and 11% when judged against points scored rather than games won. Measured against 252 other Sleeper leagues, ours sits near the **15th percentile** for how much a manager matters at all — the median league has managers differing three times as much as ours do. Nobody here pulls far ahead, because nobody here has quit.

- Busting one early pick costs about **one win**, the most expensive single thing on this page. Ten extra waiver claims are worth about a tenth of a win.

- Every figure is out of sample: each of the 56 manager-seasons was removed in turn, the model refitted without it, and used to predict the season it had never seen.

Managers with fewer than three seasons are not ranked — one year is far too noisy to place anyone.